RULES FOR VIRTUAL APPEARANCES AT DRD-CHILD SUPPORT HEARINGS
POLK, HIGHLANDS, AND HARDEE COUNTIES

1. All requests for virtual appearance must be made in writing, and must include the following information:

    a. The case number and identities of the parties at the top of the page.
    b. The name, address, e-mail address, and phone number of the party requesting virtual appearance,
    c. The reason why a virtual appearance is requested, and
    d. The requesting party's signature.

2. All requests must be filed with the Clerk of Court **where your case is pending**. Please consult your Notice of Hearing for the County in which your case is pending. Requests must be filed in person at the appropriate courthouse, through the Florida e-filing portal, or sent by U.S. Mail to the following addresses well in advance of the hearing:

POLK COUNTY:	HIGHLANDS COUNTY:	HARDEE COUNTY:
Clerk of Court	Clerk of Court	Clerk of Court
PO Box 9000	590 South Commerce Avenue	417 W. Main Street
Drawer CC-2	Sebring, FL 33870-3867	Wauchula, FL 33873
Bartow, FL 33831-9000		

3. Parties are encouraged to request virtual appearances as early as possible. A failure to request virtual appearance at least a week prior to the hearing may result in the Hearing Officer not receiving that request. Any request made but not responded to is deemed denied.

4. The Hearing Officers reserve their right to deny any request for a virtual appearance. Attending court virtually is a privilege, not a right.

5. No telephonic appearances will be permitted.

6. If a party's written request for virtual appearance is granted, the party must appear via MS Teams, with good quality video and audio, in appropriate attire, in the Child Support Hearing link located here:

    POLK COUNTY
    https://www.jud10.flcourts.org/virtual-courtroom-links/polk-child-support.

    HIGHLANDS COUNTY
    https://www.jud10.flcourts.org/virtual-courtroom-links/highlands-child-support

    HARDEE COUNTY
    https://www.jud10.flcourts.org/virtual-courtroom-links/hardee-child-support